

Outlook

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Test the mule hypothesis without labelling the customer

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

Financial Crime wants to test whether rapid receipt and onward movement forms a network pattern or reflects ordinary customer behaviour. Please start with the decision we need to make, then show whether the available evidence is strong enough to support it.

Could the answer be that new accounts act as pass-through accounts? Or are we actually seeing that shared beneficiaries connect otherwise separate customers? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that salary, family support or business cash flow explains the pattern.

We looked at a version of this before. For the August 2020 review, please show what changed and whether the earlier conclusion still holds. The practical decision is which cases deserve investigation and which monitoring rule needs a better peer group. Please send a short decision pack with no more than five slides and an attached evidence table; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations. The output is a triage hypothesis. Do not label a customer a mule without investigation and external evidence.

Regards